

Warning signs

Relapse rarely comes out of nowhere. It builds up. Your stakeholders have learned to spot the warning signs before you do.

The signs include checking the court booking app during tea, humming while you regrip a racket, mentioning a "fun padel fact" to the nursery staff, suddenly needing to "pop to the car", and starting a sentence with "Not to go on about padel, but". Lauren says the last one is the most reliable, and that it has a 100% record.

If you notice two or more of these in one day, put the phone in a drawer and ask someone a question about themselves.